

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5
 ♥ 4 3 2
 ♦ T 8 6 5
 ♣ 9 8 6 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5



♠ T 8 4 2

♥ Q J

♦ J 3 2

♣ T 7 4 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ T 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ A K 9 8 6 5
 ♦ K
 ♣ A 3 2

♠ Q T 4 2
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ Q J T 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7
 ♥ Q J 3
 ♦ A Q J T 8 7 5
 ♣ K

♠ J 9 8 5
 ♥ T 7
 ♦ 9 4 3 2
 ♣ 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♣	Pass	5NT	Pass
6 ♦	Pass	7NT	

All Pass

7NT by East

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 9 5 4 3 2
♥ 7 2
♦ 9 6 2
♣ 2

♠ -

♥ A T 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J T 8 3



♠ Q J 7

♥ 5 4

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ 9 7 5 4

♠ T 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ T

♣ A K Q 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♠

Pass

1♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

♠ 7

♥ 6 5 3

♦ A Q T 9 6 2

♣ Q 8 3



♠ A T 8 4 3

♥ Q T 8 4

♦ -

♣ K J T 2

♠ 2

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ K J 4 3

♣ 9 7 6 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

6 ♦

Pass

7 ♠

All Pass

7 ♠ by West

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 4 2
 ♥ K Q J 9 5 3
 ♦ 5
 ♣ 9 6 2

♠ K 8 7
 ♥ A T 6
 ♦ Q 9 7 4
 ♣ J T 8



♠ J 9 6 3
 ♥ 8 7 2
 ♦ J 2
 ♣ 7 5 4 3

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ 4
 ♦ A K T 8 6 3
 ♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♣	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	5 ♠	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦ s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦ s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥ A. You answer 5 ♣ and partner bids 5 ♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦ Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5 ♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7 ♦ but when you told him you had the ♦ Q, ♥ A and ♠ K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 8
 ♥ A J 9 7
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ A K Q 6

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ 5 4

♦ A 9 7 6

♣ 9 4 3



♠ -

♥ K Q T 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J T 8 2

♠ K J T 9 7 4 3

♥ -

♦ T 8 4 2

♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
			Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.